

Comp 1431 – Audit and Security

This report represents a true statement of the audit findings and conclusion undertaken by

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Audit Report

ISO 27002:2022 Section 7

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Course: Computer Forensics and Cybersecurity

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SECTION 1

Scope

This audit evaluates the physical security controls applied to student computing labs located in the Dreadnaught and Stephen Lawrence buildings at the University of Greenwich. The goal is to assess whether the facilities and measures are aligned with the controls defined in ISO27002:2022 section 7 relating to physical security. These controls are Important as they prevent unauthorized access, damage, theft or disruption of work.

The audit is limited to public student spaces in both the Dreadnaught and Stephen Lawrence buildings and it does not include private spaces, classrooms, network audit and operating systems.

In accordance to the constraints, the audit was conducted from the perspective of an average student and no communication was made to staff. The assessment was made based on the final observation of the student on 2/3/26.

SECTION 2

Business setting

The audit was conducted within the Dreadnought and Stephen Lawrence buildings at the University of Greenwich. These buildings contain student study areas and computing laboratories that provide access to information processing facilities used for academic work.

The Dreadnought building is a large three-story building that has spaces for studying, eating and socializing. The building does not require authorisation to enter; however, it also contains areas with equipment such as computers, monitors and other infrastructure used the staff and students which should be protected by physical controls.

In contrast, the Stephen Lawrence building has a controlled entry point where access is restricted to students and staff with an ID. This provides and additional layer of security.

SECTION 3

Practical Audit Method employed

The audit was conducted following a structured audit approach on guidance from ISO27002:2022 section 7 physical security controls. The audit process began with planning activities in accordance with client's requirements, the constraints and the ISO27002:2022 section 7. The primary objective was to assess physical controls that are protecting physical assets such as desktop PC's and lab equipment, etc.

Fieldwork was conducted through site visits to both buildings where the auditor assessed physical security measures present in open student study areas containing computing equipment. The audit was primarily focused on physical controls rather than technical administrative security mechanisms. Observation was the primary audit method used which involved physically inspecting the premises to compare the ISO standards given. A structured checklist was made according to ISO27002:2022 section 7 and (Yli-Karro, 2025) while keeping the constraints. The checklist included controls given in the specifications. An example of the checklist used is shown in figure 1.

ISO Ref	Control Area	Checklist Questions (Tick ✓ / ✗ / N/A)	Evidence Observed	Risk Level (H/M/L)	Comments
7.1	Physical Security Perimeter	☐ Building entry controlled?			
		☐ Reception/security present?			
		☐ Secondary secure zone for labs?			
		☐ Doors/gates functional?			
7.2	Physical Entry Controls	☐ Lab requires ID access?			
		☐ Doors auto-lock?			
		☐ Doors propped open?			
		☐ Tailgating possible?			
7.3	Securing Rooms & Facilities	☐ Doors in good condition?			
		☐ Locks robust?			
		☐ Windows secure?			
		☐ Emergency exits alarmed?			
7.6	Working in Secure Areas	☐ Supervision visible?			
		☐ Security signage displayed?			
		☐ Strangers challenged?			
		☐ Unattended equipment observed?			

Figure 1- Checklist

Evidence was collected using this checklist and notes were taken for documenting the presence or absence of security controls and potential weaknesses identified during the observation process. The checklist columns include ISO control and a checkbox to assess during the fieldwork, along with a column that documents evidence observed according to the control. The last two columns include a risk level rating and comments; risk level indicates the risk associated with the evidence observed and how it might be harmful and the comments column is for additional notes or comments made during the fieldwork.

The audit had several constraints imposed by the client. The audit was to be conducted from student's perspective and only public areas were accessible for the audit, areas such as classrooms and labs were inaccessible. Additionally, the auditor was not permitted to talk to any staff or request internal documentation.

The report structure follows standard audit reporting conventions based on the academic and professional guidance.

SECTION 4

Secure areas

1. Expected controls

The following controls are expected in accordance with ISO27002:2022 Section 7:

7.1 Physical security perimeter states that secure boundaries such as walls, controlled entry points should be implemented to protect facilities containing assets.

7.2 Physical entry controls states that areas should be restricted to authorised individuals using mechanisms such as ID cards or biometrics.

7.3 Securing offices, rooms and facilities, rooms containing IT equipment should be appropriately secured.

7.6 Working in secure areas, guidelines should be in place to ensure safe behaviour of individuals and also prevent misuse of equipment.(Iso, 2022)

2. Observed Controls and comments

7.1 - The Dreadnaught building is publicly accessible to anyone without controlled entry allowing unrestricted movement in and out of the building. Although there was no reception

secondary secure zones had controlled entry. Another issue is tailgating, where an unauthorized person might get access to secure zones by closely following an individual with an ID.

The Stephen Lawrence building had a controlled entry where students and staff with ID enter into the building. Like Dreadnaught building there was no reception present, however it might not be needed.

7.2 – It was observed that all the automated locked worked perfectly for Dreadnaught and Stephen Lawrence building and were up to the standards. Some labs were only accessible to staff and wouldn't open with a student ID. However, it was observed that a door was kept open in Dreadnaught during the fieldwork which is risk as assets such as computers were easily accessible.

7.3 – Upon observation, secure areas were up to standards. The doors were robust and had an alarm if it was kept open for more than a few minutes. The windows were kept shut most of the time reducing the risk for both the buildings.

7.6 – Students and staff were able to freely access spaces provided for work with proper signage to represent what is available to use and not. The buildings had CCTV installed for supervision. Most labs had staff present for supervision reducing the chances of exploiting the assets.

Overall, the risk is relatively low, as some controls are in place. However, some weakness such as unrestricted access and limited entry controls indicates a gap between expected and actual practices. The current control environment reduces the risk but does not completely eliminate it.

SECTION 5

Equipment security

1. Expected controls

The following controls are expected in accordance with ISO27002:2022 Section 7:

7.8 Equipment should be positioned to reduce risks from environmental threats and authorised access, including physical safeguards.

7.11 Equipment should be protected from power failures and disruptions through supporting utilities and backup systems.

7.12 Power and data cables should be protected from damage and interception. Cables should be managed and secured and if possible, securely enclosed.(Iso, 2022)

2. Observed controls and comments

7.8 Most equipment was positioned securely on desks, and the equipment near windows lacked additional protection such as locks and restraints. Monitors were not physically secured to the desks which can be a risk. This indicates partial compliance and although the equipment is appropriately placed for usability and inaccessible to those without a proper ID, they were accessible through various means such as tailgating. Equipment placed near windows may be exposed to environmental risks.

7.11 No clear evidence of backup power systems was observed. There were trailing cables and over reliance on standard power sockets with no visible contingency in place. In case of disruption in event of power failure, it might cause a disruption of services and this indicates a gap between expected and actual controls.

7.12 Cables were inconsistently managed, some were enclosed in trunking others were exposed across floors, especially the extension power socket stands on the ground floor. Network cables were observed to be exposed in certain locations where tampering can be a risk. This is a control weakness and exposed cables should be properly protected especially the power cables.

Overall, equipment security is assessed as moderate, with basic controls in place but it is inconsistently applied. The equipment is generally functional and accessible, weakness in cabling protection and power back up increases the risks of disruption.

SECTION 6

Audit conclusion

1. Overall conclusion based on relevant GAP analysis

A gap analysis indicated the difference the physical standards and the measures that are present.

Control Area	Good	Needs some attention	Needs much attention
7.1 Physical Security Perimeter			
7.2 Physical Entry Controls			
7.3 Securing Rooms			
7.6 Working in Secure Areas			
7.8 Equipment Protection			
7.11 Supporting Utilities			
7.12 Cabling Security			

Table 1 GAP analysis

GAP analysis-

2/7 = 42.8% compliant

GAP = 100 – 42.8 = 57.2%

The GAP analysis conducted highlights a clear difference between the expected controls defined in ISO27002:2022 and the controls observed during the audit. Out of seven control areas only two were found to be fully compliant resulting in an overall compliance of 42.8% and a gap of 57.2%. Two of the most critical weaknesses were the physical entry controls and cabling security as they represent risks and potential service disruption.

The overall qualified audit opinion is that the organisation has partial compliance with ISO27002:2022 standards, with few areas requiring immediate attention to improve the security posture.

2. Recommendation for Immediate and Future Management Action

High Priority-

- Introduce access control such as ID card systems to restrict entry into the Dreadnaught building.
- Ensuring all cables is properly handled and enclosed to prevent accidental damage or tampering.

Medium Priority-

- Improve equipment protection such as cable locks and secured monitor setups to reduce theft risk
- Implementing a UPS or a backup power system in the buildings is a must for continuity of operations.

Low priority-

- Securing rooms and working in secure areas should regularly maintained and checked for any flaw.
- Regular monitoring of these areas should be implemented by the organization.

References

- Iso. (2022). *Information security, cybersecurity and privacy protection-Information security management systems-Requirements.*
- Yli-Karro, V. (2025). *Ensuring NIS 2 compliance in an ISO/IEC 27001 certified organization:*
- Audit and security comp 1431 lecture 4

Appendix A

WORK IN PROGRESS REPORT

PROJECT TITLE: Audit of Dreadnaught and Stephen Lawrance building.

TYPE OF REPORT (INITIAL OR INTERMEDIATE): Initial

DATE OF COMPILATION OF THIS WIP REPORT: 1/3/26

AUTHOR OF THIS WIP REPORT: 001480855

PROGRESS SO FAR:

Has initial plan and timetable been created? Yes, a plan has been developed.

Has work so far progressed well with no change to plan? Yes progress is currently going as planned.

Tasks identified and put into action to date. Actions performed so far:

- Reviewed the Coursework and its specifications.
- Identified the constraints
- Designed the checklist
- Conducted initial visit to the buildings

PROBLEMS AND ISSUES ENCOUNTERED:

Were any particular issues identified so far which might be problematic? What are they?

- Access restrictions to only public areas
- Some controls cannot be fully observed for example power backup.

PLANS FOR THE NEXT STAGE OF THE PROJECT:

To continue as per initial plan which means doing: Yes

Extra actions not foreseen initially but might involve : Revisiting the buildings

Intermediate WIP Report planned for compilation on: 5/3/26

PROBLEMS AND ISSUES THAT MIGHT BE ENCOUNTERED:

Is overall plan slippage a possibility with possible issues that might arise being: No

What confidence that deadline will be met? High, current progress is on schedule.

WORK IN PROGRESS REPORT

PROJECT TITLE: Audit of Dreadnaught and Stephen Lawrance building.

TYPE OF REPORT (INITIAL OR INTERMEDIATE): Intermediate

DATE OF COMPILATION OF THIS WIP REPORT: 6/3/26

AUTHOR OF THIS WIP REPORT: 001480855

PROGRESS SO FAR:

Has initial plan and timetable been created? Yes, a plan has been followed.

Has work so far progressed well with no change to plan? Yes progress is currently going as planned.

Tasks identified and put into action to date. Actions performed so far:

- Completed the fieldwork
- Started with the audit report
- Conducted GAP analysis

PROBLEMS AND ISSUES ENCOUNTERED:

Were any particular issues identified so far which might be problematic? What are they?

- Access restrictions to only public areas
- Some observations were subjective due to lack of direct evidence.
- Some controls cannot be fully observed for example power backup.

PLANS FOR THE NEXT STAGE OF THE PROJECT:

To continue as per initial plan which means doing:

Extra actions not foreseen initially but might involve : Reviewing the report and completing the audit.

PROBLEMS AND ISSUES THAT MIGHT BE ENCOUNTERED:

Is overall plan slippage a possibility with possible issues that might arise being: No

What confidence that deadline will be met? High, current progress is on schedule.